

Kara Novotny

Orange, CA • (714) 317-8359 • karaashbeck@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/kashbeck • github.com/maughtycat

Professional Summary

AI Content Engineer and Technical Writer specializing in docs-as-code workflows, LLM prompt engineering, and AI-driven content pipelines. Seven years of experience building documentation systems that scale — from structured JSON output validation and multi-step agent pipelines to Markdown-first docs-as-code architectures. Currently building Chronicles of the Six Houses (CoSH), an AI-driven narrative RPG custom-engineered in React/TypeScript, featuring a prompt generation pipeline with structured output schemas, NPC state management for 122 characters, and programmatic LLM output validation across 43 narrative state flags. — Read the case study →

Core Skills

AI Coding Agents: Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, Cursor, Cline, Hermes Agent, Kilo

AI & Prompt Engineering: LLM prompt engineering, structured JSON output schemas, multi-step agent pipelines, AI content validation, Gemini, ChatGPT, Copilot, AI workflow automation, model output post-processing, model evaluation and selection, OpenRouter (multi-model routing for cost and quality optimization)

Docs-as-Code & Technical Writing: Markdown, Git, MadCap Flare, API documentation (OpenAPI/Swagger), UX writing, information architecture, single sourcing, content strategy, release notes, Confluence, Zendesk

Developer Tools & Frameworks: React, TypeScript, Node.js, Jira, Figma, CI/CD pipelines, version control

Methodology: Agile (Scrum/Kanban), cross-functional collaboration, stakeholder management, data-driven content iteration

Professional Experience

Technical Writer & AI Workflow Engineer — Redwood Software Aug 2024 - Jun 2026

- Led a complete redesign and content overhaul of the Finance Automation help site (~200 articles) — from a broken, unnavigable flat-fragile HTML site with zero accessibility to a fully ADA-compliant, searchable, role-aware documentation portal using MadCap Flare, Claude Code, and Cursor; audited source code to reconstruct missing institutional knowledge after key engineers departed, and implemented UX improvements praised by customers and product managers, eliminating weekly customer success escalations entirely
- Built an intelligent PDF pipeline with Cursor that dynamically reformatted content and styling based on output format (PDF vs. HTML) — solving a years-long customer complaint about missing PDF documentation that had been dropped during a previous Flare migration
- Redesigned the Finance Automation release notes format from a sparse product-version table into a structured, categorized "What's New" layout with sections for integrations, component enhancements, and tracked fixes with version IDs, directly improving how customers discovered and adopted new features
- Architected AI-powered documentation workflows: built FlareGuard, a custom Gemini Gem suite developed during the Docs/Ed department's Innovation Week, automating style guide enforcement, sprint estimation, and release note classification; migrated workflow

automation to Claude Code and then Cursor in early 2026, moving from copy-paste AI tools to agentic coding agents operating directly on the docs codebase

- Engineered an AI-powered product storytelling presentation (Redwood Tinder) reimagining platform capabilities as character-driven narratives — recognized internally for creativity and innovation; created a dedicated Sandbox branch of the help site to prototype interactive product simulations, role-aware help menus, and context-sensitive navigation

Technical Writer — Attentive

Sep 2021 - Sep 2023

- Created and maintained help center articles and integration guides for Attentive's SMS marketing platform using Google Docs, Confluence, and Monday, serving marketer and business user audiences
- Implemented single sourcing and modular writing best practices to ensure scalability and maintainability across the knowledge base
- Obtained UX Writing Certificate from UX Content Collective — applied UX design principles to create user-centered documentation that improved content engagement
- Collaborated with engineering, product, and marketing in Agile sprints to maintain documentation accuracy and release cadence, synthesizing qualitative and quantitative research into content decisions

Associate Technical Writer — Bird (Bird Rides)

Jul 2019 - Sep 2021

- Developed comprehensive user guide for BirdOne (first retail e-scooter) in cross-disciplinary collaboration with Brand, Retail, and Vehicle teams — recognized company-wide for documentation excellence
- Created and managed vehicle hardware and repair SOPs using MadCap Flare with conditional tags for multi-role content targeting
- Migrated 500+ instructional content pieces from Dozuki to Zendesk Help Center ahead of deadline — received company-wide recognition at an all-hands meeting
- Pioneered use of instructional GIFs for non-English-speaking markets, improving support accessibility across international user base

Technical Writer & Release Manager — Wynne Systems

May 2017 - Jan 2019

- Authored and maintained documentation for ERP software serving the rental and construction industry using MadCap Flare and MS Office, standardizing documentation processes that reduced revision time
- Managed software release scheduling and cross-departmental coordination on Jira, ensuring alignment between engineering, product, and end-user documentation

AI Content Engineering — Personal Project

Chronicles of the Six Houses (CoSH) — AI Content Engineer

Dec 2025 - Present

React/TypeScript — Private repo (case study: maughtycat.github.io/portfolio/projects/cosh.html)

- Architected and built an AI-driven narrative RPG engine in React/TypeScript, featuring a custom LLM quest-generation pipeline with structured JSON output schemas, NPC state management, and multi-step event chains
- Designed a prompt engineering system generating dynamic narrative content across 6 houses, 122 NPCs, and 18+ romance quest lines, with programmatic validation ensuring lore consistency and output integrity

- Implemented a flag/condition system gating 43 narrative triggers (NPC availability, quest progression, romance paths, festival attendance), functioning as a game-state-aware content routing engine
- Built NPC attendance, relationship, and bond subsystems with automated event generation, timeline progression, and dynamic cast selection filtered by unlock conditions and player state
- Enforced structured output validation (strict key allowlists, schema enforcement, post-processing guards) preventing LLM hallucination in named entities, house references, and cross-NPC relationships

Education

Bachelor of Arts in Screenwriting, Cum Laude — Chapman University, 2017 • GPA: 3.6

Certifications

UX Writing — UX Content Collective